



CONJUNCTIONS

The words that join other words and ideas together

1 What is it?

Conjunctions (kun-JUNK-shunz)

A conjunction is a word used to connect words, phrases, or clauses within a sentence, showing how the ideas relate to each other.

joins + two ideas together

2 See it in action

Adding

"I like tea **and** coffee."

Contrasting

"She was tired, **but** she kept going."

Choice

"You can walk **or** take the bus."

Reason/result

"He left early **because** he felt unwell."



You got this!

Try the FANBOYS trick — for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so — to quickly recall every coordinating conjunction.

3 More to know

Correlative

"**Either** you come with us **or** you stay behind."

Subordinating

"**Although** it rained, we still went out, **since** we had umbrellas."

FUN FACT

The acronym "FANBOYS" (for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so) was popularised as a memory trick in American classrooms in the 1990s and has since spread worldwide as the standard way to remember coordinating conjunctions.

4 Why it's used

Conjunctions help: connect ideas smoothly so writing doesn't come out as a string of short, disconnected sentences.

Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so) join equal ideas. Subordinating conjunctions (because, although, since, if) join a main idea to a dependent one.



Think about...

If a conjunction joins a main idea to a dependent one (because, although, since), it's subordinating, not coordinating.

5 Where you'll spot it

Coordinating

Join two equal, independent ideas: and, but, or, so, yet, for, nor (remember: FANBOYS).

Subordinating

Join a main clause to a dependent one: because, although, since, if, when, unless.

⚠ Watch out!

Starting a sentence with "And" or "But" isn't actually grammatically wrong in modern English — professional writers do it often for effect — but overusing it can make writing feel choppy.

6 Quick recap

Joins words/ideas

Coordinating or subordinating

FANBOYS = the coordinating set



Look here!

A sentence with too many 'and's strung together can feel like a run-on — try breaking it into two sentences instead.